SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #31 · TRUTH

“Whatever my church teaches must be biblical.”

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Where it often comes from

Growing up in a church that discouraged questions. Deep loyalty to a pastor or denomination that helped you. Fear that checking teaching means doubting God. Not knowing how to study the Bible for yourself. Being told that leaders are always right or that questioning is rebellion.

What Scripture teaches

Good churches and faithful teachers are a gift from God, and we should respect them. But every church is made up of imperfect people. Scripture praises the Bereans, who received Paul’s message eagerly and then examined the Scriptures every day to see if it was true. We are told to test all things and hold fast to what is good. God’s Word is the final authority, and a healthy church welcomes being measured by it.

> *“Now the Bereans were more noble-minded than the Thessalonians, for they received the message with great eagerness and examined the Scriptures every day to see if these teachings were true”* **(Acts 17:11)**.

Also see

> “But test all things. Hold fast to what is good” **(1 Thessalonians 5:21)**.

> “All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for instruction, for conviction, for correction, and for training in righteousness, so that the man of God may be complete, fully equipped for every good work” **(2 Timothy 3:16–17)**.

> “But even if we or an angel from heaven should preach a gospel contrary to the one we preached to you, let him be under a curse!” **(Galatians 1:8)**.

> “The entirety of Your word is truth, and all Your righteous judgments endure forever” **(Psalm 119:160)**.

Common self-statements

- If my church says it, it must be true.
- Checking the Bible for myself would be disloyal.
- My pastor is never wrong.
- Asking questions shows a lack of faith.
- Other churches are wrong, so mine must be right about everything.
- I don’t need to read the Bible; my church tells me what it says.

Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing your church must be either completely right or completely wrong.
- **Appeal to authority:** Accepting a teaching because of who said it rather than what Scripture says.
- **Fear-based thinking:** Avoiding questions because you fear what you might find.
- **Overgeneralization:** Assuming that because your church is right on many things, it is right on all things.

Challenging questions

- What did the Bereans do with Paul's teaching, and why were they praised?
- Can a church be good and still be wrong on some points?
- Have I ever checked this teaching in Scripture for myself?
- Would a healthy church be afraid of being tested by the Bible?
- What does 1 Thessalonians 5:21 ask me to do?
- Is my loyalty to my church greater than my loyalty to God's Word?
- Who could help me study this question honestly?

Truth summary

> My church is a gift, but it is not perfect. God's Word is the final authority. Like the Bereans, I can receive teaching eagerly and also check it against Scripture. Testing what I hear is not disloyalty; it is faithfulness. I can respect my leaders and still hold fast to what the Bible says.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Truth
- Scripture/Word
- Church
- Wisdom
- Belief

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Whatever my church teaches must be biblical"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Whatever my church teaches must be biblical." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did the Bereans do, and why were they praised?
- ☐ Can a good church be wrong on some points?
- ☐ Have I checked this teaching myself?
- ☐ Would a healthy church fear being tested by the Bible?
- ☐ Is my loyalty to my church greater than to God's Word?
- ☐ Who could help me study this honestly?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's Word is the final authority.
- ☐ I can test all things and hold fast to what is good.
- ☐ Checking teaching against Scripture is faithful, not disloyal.
- ☐ I can respect my leaders and still read the Bible for myself.
- ☐ All Scripture is God-breathed and useful.
- ☐ My church is a gift, but it is not perfect.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Acts 17:11**
  "Now the Bereans were more noble-minded than the Thessalonians, for they received the message with great eagerness and examined the Scriptures every day to see if these teachings were true."
- [ ] **1 Thessalonians 5:21**
  "But test all things. Hold fast to what is good."
- [ ] **2 Timothy 3:16–17**
  "All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for instruction, for conviction, for correction, and for training in righteousness, so that the man of God may be complete, fully equipped for every good work."
- [ ] **Galatians 1:8**
  "But even if we or an angel from heaven should preach a gospel contrary to the one we preached to you, let him be under a curse!"
- [ ] **Psalm 119:160**
  "The entirety of Your word is truth, and all Your righteous judgments endure forever."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Berean log:** Each week, write one thing I heard taught and the verses I checked it against.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 1 Thessalonians 5:21 becomes: "But **Sarah** should test all things and hold fast to what is good."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Truth" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Choose one teaching from your church** and look up what the Bible says about it, using a concordance or study Bible.
- ☐ **Read Acts 17:10–12,** and write down what made the Bereans "noble-minded."
- ☐ **Ask your pastor respectfully:** "Where does the Bible teach this?" Notice how the question is received.
- ☐ **Read one book of the Bible straight through this month** on your own, not just in sermon portions.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Whatever my church teaches must be biblical": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One teaching I checked in Scripture
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Whatever my church teaches must be biblical.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for my church and for faithful teachers. Help me reject the lie that whatever my church teaches must be biblical. Give me the heart of the Bereans, eager to learn and careful to check everything against Your Word. Let Your Word be my final authority. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.